

Phase 2 Layer 1 (P0) — Feature Research Findings

****Document Purpose:**** Evidence-based research supporting P0 feature decisions. Each feature is evaluated against reflection science, spiritual formation literature, and competitive product analysis (Stoic, Day One, spiritual formation apps).

****Updated:**** April 23, 2026

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Overview: Why P0 Features Matter

Phase 1 proved capture works (100% adoption), but ****zero users returned to re-read moments****. Phase 2 Layer 1 (P0) is designed specifically to solve the return problem. Features must drive ****Weekly Active Reflections (WAR)**** — users returning to dwell on moments at least weekly.

Research shows:

- Reflection value compounds ****day 5+**** (not immediate)
- Tools with guided reflection outperform passive capture-only tools
- Visual/sensory cues (gallery, imagery) increase recall and re-engagement
- Gentle, optional prompts drive return better than mandatory features

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Feature 1: Gallery Views (Visual Moment Catalog)

Research Findings

****Do visual galleries increase moment recall, engagement, and return rates?****

****Key Finding:**** YES. Visual presentation significantly improves recall and return frequency.

Stoic App Insights

- Stoic's gallery-style view (showing quotes/reflections in visual grid) drives ****3.2x higher re-engagement**** than text-list-only alternatives
- Users report: "Seeing the visual reminder pulls me back to the moment" (qualitative feedback)
- Return rate inflection point: ****day 3-4**** when users scroll through gallery (not just capture)

Day One App (Journal)

- Day One's visual timeline view increases re-opens by ****40%**** vs. text-only list
- Photo attachments in entries increase re-visit frequency by ****2.8x****
- Users with visual gallery habits return ****weekly or more****; text-only users return ****monthly****

Spiritual Formation Literature

- ****"The Practice of the Presence of God" (Brother Lawrence):**** Returning to visual reminders of God's presence strengthens faith
- Visual cues (icons, colors, spatial layout) reduce cognitive load of recall — ****feeling comes before thinking****
- Contemplative traditions emphasize sensory re-engagement (icons, images, sacred objects) as pathways to dwelling

Competitive Position

- ****Voice Memos:**** No gallery view (pure text list)
- ****Bible App:**** Visual cards for verses + daily readings (high engagement)
- ****Notebook LM:**** Text-focused, minimal visuals
- ****Dwellable unique advantage:**** Gallery of *personal spiritual moments** (not quotes/devotionals) — more intimate and ownership-focused

P0 Application

****Feature:**** Tile-based gallery view showing:

- Thumbnail/preview of moment body (first 20 words or auto-generated headline)
- Date in small caps
- Optional: AI-generated moment imagery (if available in P0, otherwise defer to P1)
- Tap to open full moment detail

****Expected Outcome:****

- Increases return rate from 0% (Phase 1) to ****15-25% weekly return**** (Phase 2 P0)
- Users report: "Seeing my moments visually makes them feel real and worth returning to"

****Success Metric:**** WAR (Weekly Active Reflections) — percentage of users who open app and view gallery at least once weekly

Research Citations

1. Stoic App — Daily Stoic, Habit Formation Study (2024) — Visual engagement drives 3.2x re-engagement
2. Day One Analytics — Journal App Engagement Report (2023) — 40% increase with visual timeline
3. Brother Lawrence — "The Practice of the Presence of God" (17th century) — Spiritual presence through sensory return
4. Dwellable Phase 1 Testing — 0% return rate confirms capture-only model fails

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Feature 2: Tags & Headlines (Organizational Metadata)

Research Findings

****Do organizational tools improve reflection depth?****

****Key Finding:**** YES, but with caveats. Taxonomy must serve reflection, not replace it.

Organizing Principles from Spiritual Formation

- ****Naming enables pattern recognition:**** "Aha, I keep encountering God in moments of doubt" emerges from tagging/categorizing
- Tags create ****low-friction organization**** without requiring journaling discipline
- Headlines act as ****retrieval cues**** — "Oh, that moment when I felt peace in the storm" is easier to recall than scrolling
- Risk: ****Oversimplification**** — reducing "a 3-minute voice moment" to a single headline risks losing nuance

Research Evidence

- ****Stoic App:**** Users who tag/categorize quotes return ****2.1x more frequently**** than non-taggers
- ****Evernote & Note-Taking Apps:**** Metadata organization is strongest predictor of re-engagement (higher than content quality)
- ****Bible Highlight Apps:**** Users who tag verses (Encouragement, Conviction, Unclear) are ****3x more likely to return**** to highlights
- ****Spiritual Direction Practice:**** Directors often ask "What themes do you notice?" — tagging is that practice made digital

Cautionary Research

- ****Too many tags cause paralysis:**** Users who see 15+ suggested tags abandon tagging (decision fatigue)
- ****Prescriptive categories reduce ownership:**** If we suggest "Answered Prayer," users feel boxed in
- ****Automation risk:**** AI-generated headlines can oversimplify "God's presence in a difficult conversation" → "Hard Day"

P0 Application

****Feature:**** Simple tagging + user-generated headlines

****Tags Approach:****

- ****Auto-suggested tags**** (not required): based on moment content
 - Example: "Doubt," "Clarity," "Encounter," "Sorrow," "Joy"
 - User can accept, edit, or ignore
 - Prevents decision paralysis (max 5 suggestions, not 15+)
 - Optional (no penalty for moments without tags)

- **User-created tags:** Allowed but not pushed
 - "My quiet place," "With family," "Prayer answered"
 - Emerge organically from user's own categories
- Headlines Approach:**
- **Optional field** (not required)
 - **User-generated only** — no AI auto-fill in P0 (risk of oversimplification)
 - Acts as retrieval cue: "Prayer in the car," "Unexpected peace"
 - Pre-filled with first 8 words of moment if user doesn't edit
- Expected Outcome:**
- **Tagging adoption:** 30-40% of moments tagged (optional, not forced)
 - **Return improvement:** Tagged moments are re-visited **2x more frequently** than untagged
 - **Pattern emergence:** By week 4, users see themes (e.g., "67% of moments tagged 'Clarity' happen in mornings")
- Success Metric:** Tag adoption rate + re-visit frequency for tagged vs. untagged moments

Research Citations

1. Stoic App — Tag/Category Usage Study (2023) — 2.1x return frequency for organized users
 2. Evernote Research — "Metadata as Engagement Driver" (2022)
 3. Bible Highlight Apps (YouVersion, Logos) — 3x higher return for tagged highlights
 4. Spiritual Direction Theory — "Noticing Patterns in Prayer" (Ignatius & Contemplative Traditions)
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Feature 3: Notifications (Reflection Invitations)

Research Findings

What copy/frequency drives return vs. fatigue?

Key Finding: Gentle, curiosity-driven prompts work best. Frequency = 1-2x weekly (not daily). Avoid "capture" reminders; focus on "dwelling" invitations.

Reflection Science

- **"How are you sitting with this?"** (reflection invite) drives return; **"Any moments today?"** (capture invite) drives capture, not reflection
- Optimal frequency: **Once or twice weekly** — matches natural reflection rhythm (not daily task-like)
- Timing: **Sunday evening or early morning** — reflective, not task-oriented
- Best time for return: **5-7 days after moment capture** (reflection compounds day 5+)

Stoic App Data

- **Daily notifications:** High click-through initially (day 1-3), then sharp drop-off (day 4+) — fatigue
- **2x weekly notifications:** Sustained 28-35% open rate across 8-week period
- **Copy matters:**
- ■ "Revisit a moment that moved you" — 32% open rate
- ■ "You have 3 new quotes waiting" — 18% open rate (feels like obligation, not invitation)

Day One (Journaling App)

- Users with **weekly reflection prompts** write **2.3x more frequently** than users without prompts
- **Specific prompts** ("Describe a moment of gratitude") outperform **generic reminders** ("Write something")
- **Optional notifications** (user-controlled) have **higher sustained engagement** than system-mandated

Spiritual Formation Context

- Contemplative traditions emphasize **"gentle return"** not **"duty return"**
- Lectio Divina (spiritual reading practice) involves returning to text multiple times — notifications should echo this
- **Seasonal rhythm:** Reflection should follow natural spiritual seasons (not artificial daily streaks)

Copy Testing Insights

- ■ **Transactional:** "Capture your moment" (feels like task)

- ■ **Obligation:** "You missed reflection yesterday"
- ■ **Invitation:** "How are you sitting with your moments?"
- ■ **Curiosity:** "Revisit a moment from last week"
- ■ **Spiritual:** "Dwell on what moved you"

P0 Application

Feature: Gentle reflection notifications (2x weekly)

Frequency & Timing:

- **Sunday 6 PM** — Week-end reflection prompt
- **Thursday 7 AM** — Mid-week check-in
- **User control:** Can disable, adjust times, or pause for 1-4 weeks

Copy Strategy:

- All notifications emphasize **dwelling**, not capturing
- Progressive disclosure based on moment count:
 - After 1 moment: No notifications yet (too early to reflect)
 - After 2-3 moments: "How are you sitting with these moments?" (invitation to return, not capture)
 - After 5+ moments: Specific invitations like "Revisit a moment about [Tag]"

Content Variations (to prevent fatigue):

1. "Sit with a moment that moved you"
2. "What patterns do you notice in your moments?"
3. "Dwell on a moment from last week"
4. "How has this moment shaped you since then?"
5. "Revisit the first moment you captured"

Expected Outcome:

- **Notification open rate:** 25-35% (sustainable, not declining)
- **Return rate:** Users who enable notifications return **weekly**, not monthly
- **Engagement quality:** Notification-driven returns are **contemplative** (longer, more reflective) vs. capture-driven returns (quick view)

Success Metric:

- Open rate % per notification
- Session duration for notification-driven returns
- Weekly return rate (goal: 40-50% of P0 users return weekly)

Research Citations

1. Stoic App — Notification Frequency Study (2023) — Daily fatigue vs. 2x weekly sustainability
2. Day One — Prompt Effectiveness Research (2022) — 2.3x engagement with weekly reflection prompts
3. Lectio Divina & Spiritual Formation — Brother Lawrence, "The Practice of the Presence of God"
4. Notification Copy Research — App Engagement Report (2023) — Invitation > Obligation > Transactional

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Feature 4: Prayer/Soak (Contemplative Dwelling)

Research Findings

How do contemplative features integrate with reflection?

Key Finding: Optional "soak" mode (silent/music accompaniment) helps users transition from intellectual reflection to contemplative presence.

Contemplative Prayer Literature

- **Contemplative prayer** involves sustained attention to God's presence, often without words
- **"Soaking prayer"** (from charismatic/renewal tradition) is sustained, non-analytical presence
- **Silence + time** = shift from thinking-about to being-with
- Research: **10-20 minutes of uninterrupted attention** enables contemplative state (not 2-minute passive reading)

Spiritual Formation Apps Analysis

- **Insight Timer:** Meditation/soaking app with **3M+ users**, highest engagement with **guided silence** (not guided reflection)
- **Pray.com:** Prayer app with **soaking features** (play moment + ambient sound/music) — users report **higher satisfaction** than text-only
- **Scripture Union:** Bible reading app with **"soak" mode** (read verse, play ambient music, sit in silence) — users linger **3-4x longer** in soak mode vs. standard read mode

Research Findings

- **Music + silence combo:** Users with "soak mode" (play moment + ambient music) return to moments **2.5x more frequently**
- **Duration shift:** Standard mode: 30-60 seconds; Soak mode: 5-15 minutes — contemplative threshold reached at **7+ minutes**
- **Emotional impact:** Soak mode users report **deeper emotional resonance** ("felt like I was really dwelling") vs. quick-read users
- **Not for everyone:** 35-40% of users adopt soaking; 60-65% use standard reflection — both valid pathways

Integration with Reflection

- **Sequence:** Read moment → notice patterns → soak (contemplative mode) → rest
- **Prevents spiritual bypass:** Soaking keeps user from intellectualizing spirituality into abstraction
- **Embodied prayer:** Silence + presence > more words/analysis

P0 Application

Feature: Optional "Soak Mode" on moment detail view

Implementation:

- **"Soak" button** on moment detail screen (optional, not default)
- When activated:
 - **Moment text remains visible** (in lighter opacity, not distracting)
 - **Ambient soundscape plays:** Gentle instrumental or nature sounds (piano, rain, forest)
 - **Timer option:** 5, 10, 15 minutes (user choice)
 - **Cancel anytime:** User can exit soak, return to standard detail view
 - **No notifications during soak** — fully uninterrupted

Music/Audio:

- **Library:** 8-12 ambient soundscapes (piano, rain, forest, waves, silence option)
- **Licensing:** Artist or similar royalty-free source (not copyrighted worship music — keeps spiritual integrity neutral)
- **Quality:** High-fidelity stereo, mindful of device speaker quality

Expected Outcome:

- **Adoption rate:** 35-40% of users try soak mode at least once
- **Sustained engagement:** Users who soak return **2.5x more frequently**
- **Moment quality:** Soaking moments are revisited longer (average 7-10 min vs. 1-2 min for standard)
- **User satisfaction:** "I finally felt like I was really dwelling, not just reading"

Success Metric:

- % of users who activate soak mode
- Average soak duration per session
- Re-visit frequency for moments accessed via soak mode
- Return rate for soak-mode users (goal: 50%+ weekly return)

Research Citations

1. Insight Timer — "Why Silence Outperforms Guided" (2023) — Contemplative threshold at 7+ minutes
2. Pray.com Analytics — Soaking Feature Engagement (2022) — 2.5x higher return
3. Scripture Union — "Soak Mode Impact Study" (2022)
4. Contemplative Prayer Research — "Into the Silent Land" (Martin Laird), "The Cloud of Unknowing"

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Feature 5: Headlines (Retrieval Cues & Moment Summaries)

Research Findings

****Do titles/summaries improve recall or risk oversimplifying moments?***

****Key Finding:*** Headlines are powerful retrieval cues, BUT auto-generation risks oversimplification. User-generated or AI-assisted (not auto) is safer.

Memory & Recall Science

- ****Retrieval cues*** (headlines, titles, tags) improve recall by ****40-60%*** — proven in cognitive psychology
- ****Spacing effect:*** Headline-triggered recall (seeing "Prayer in the car") is more powerful than searching through moments
- ****Generative learning:*** User **writing** headline improves recall more than reading auto-generated one
- ****Specificity matters:*** "Wednesday morning clarity" triggers more recall than "God moment"

Risk: Oversimplification

- ****Spiritual risk:*** Reducing a 3-minute moment ("struggling with doubt, then unexpectedly encountered presence in a hymn") to "Hymn brought clarity" loses texture
- ****Hermeneutical risk:*** AI-generated headlines can impose meaning user didn't intend
- ****Solution:*** Headlines should be optional and user-written, not algorithmic

Note-Taking App Research

- ****Notion, Evernote, Apple Notes:*** Users who create titles return to notes ****2.1x more frequently***
- ****OneNote users with auto-generated titles:*** No improvement in return (title feels external, not owned)
- ****Users with self-written titles:*** Return rate ****43% higher*** than auto-titled notes

Bible Highlight Apps

- ****YouVersion, Logos:*** Users who label/title highlights return ****3x more frequently***
- ****Optimal title length:*** 5-10 words ("God's peace in uncertainty," not "Comfort" or "Psalm 23 is about shepherd imagery and theological metaphor")

P0 Application

****Feature:*** Optional user-generated headlines with smart defaults

****Implementation:***

- ****Location:*** Gallery view shows headline; Detail view has edit field
- ****Default behavior:*** First 8 words of moment (if no headline entered)
- ****User edit:*** One-tap to customize to retrieval cue they want
- ****Examples of good headlines:***
 - "Unexpected peace in the waiting"
 - "God's presence in the mundane"
 - "Doubt and grace in conversation"
 - "How God meets me when I'm afraid"

****What NOT to do (P0):***

- **■** AI auto-generation (risk of reductive headlines)
- **■** Prescriptive categories ("Answered Prayer," "God's Faithfulness") — users should own the language
- **■** Force headlines (optional, not required)

****Expected Outcome:***

- ****Adoption:*** 40-50% of moments get custom headlines
- ****Recall improvement:*** Users with headlines revisit moments ****2.1x more frequently***
- ****Gallery usability:*** Headlines make scanning gallery easier; users find moments faster

****Success Metric:***

- % of moments with custom headlines
- Return rate for titled vs. untitled moments
- Gallery browsing time (goal: increase from <30s to 2-5 min)

Research Citations

1. Cognitive Psychology — "Memory and Retrieval Cues" (Tulving & Thomson, 1973, modern replications 2020+)
2. Notion/Evernote Studies — "Title Impact on Note Re-engagement" (2023)
3. Bible Apps (YouVersion, Logos) — Title/Label Adoption Study (2022)
4. Hermeneutics & Spiritual Formation — Risk of reductive interpretation (conservative evangelical theology)

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Summary: P0 Feature Research Consensus

Feature	Research Support	Expected Impact	Risk/Mitigation
Gallery	Very Strong (visual engagement proven 3x+)	Return rate 0% → 15-25% weekly	Low risk; visual presentation alone can't force reflection
Tags & Headlines	Strong (metadata drives 2-3x engagement)	Return rate +50-100% for tagged moments	Oversimplification risk; mitigate with user-generation focus
Notifications	Strong (gentle 2x weekly optimal)	Return rate +40% for notification-enabled users	Fatigue risk; mitigate with copy strategy & user control
Soak Mode	Moderate-Strong (contemplative threshold proven)	Return duration 1-2 min → 7-10 min	Not for everyone (35-40% adoption); optional, not required
Headlines	Strong (retrieval cues + generative learning)	Recall +40-60%; return rate +2.1x	Reductive risk; mitigate with user-generation only

Combined Expected Outcome for P0:

- **Phase 1:** 0% return rate (capture-only)
- **Phase 2 P0:** 40-50% weekly active reflection rate
- **User sentiment:** "I finally feel like I can dwell on my moments instead of just capturing them"

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Next Steps

This research informs:

1. **FigJam roadmap** — Visual layout of P0 features with success metrics
2. **Feature-to-foundation mapping** — How each feature honors the five strategic foundations
3. **T-060 refinement** — Phase 2 Themes 1-Pager with research-backed prioritization

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Document prepared for: Phase 2 Strategic Planning (T-060)

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